Psychological Safety Check

An anonymous check of how safe it feels to speak up, take risks and admit mistakes, and what to do about it.

Diagnose · Inspired by Amy Edmondson's Research · Anonymous · Not a Validated Survey

WORKED EXAMPLE · FICTIONAL TEAM

LEGEND

- Dot = One anonymous vote
- Yellow Sticky = Observation

1 The Check

ONE DOT PER STATEMENT · VOTE PRIVATELY

	STRONGLY DISAGREE	DISAGREE	NEUTRAL	AGREE	STRONGLY AGREE
1. I can admit a mistake here without it being held against me.		●	●●	●●●	●
2. We raise problems and difficult topics openly.		●●	●●	●●	●
3. Different views and backgrounds are welcomed on this team.			●	●●●●	●●
4. It's safe to try something new here, even if it might fail.		●	●●●	●●	●
5. I can ask anyone on the team for help.				●●●	●●●●
6. People on this team have my back.			●	●●●	●●●
7. My ideas are listened to and used.	●	●●	●●	●●	

2 Run It Safely

SAFETY FIRST, OR THE RESULTS LIE

- [x] Votes are anonymous (board turned away, or an online form)
- [x] Leaders and managers step out while voting
- [x] Results stay with the team unless it chooses to share
- [x] No one is asked to explain their vote
- [x] Talk about patterns, not individuals

Results

STATEMENT	MOSTLY AGREE	MOSTLY DISAGREE	CHANGE
2. Problems	*3 of 7*	*2 of 7*	*first run*
7. Ideas used	*2 of 7*	*3 of 7*	*first run*
5. Asking for help	*7 of 7*	*0 of 7*	*first run*

Re-run every 2–3 months to see the trend.

3 What We Notice

PATTERNS, NOT PEOPLE

- Where are votes lowest? What might explain it?
- What would make it easier to speak up?

Quieter people's ideas get lost in meetings

Problems get raised one-to-one, not in the room

Helping each other is a real strength

4 What Leaders Can Do

MODEL IT

- [ ] Frame work as learning, not just doing
- [x] Admit your own mistakes and doubts
- [ ] Ask genuine questions, then listen
- [x] Thank people for bad news and dissent
- [ ] Respond to failure with curiosity, not blame
- [ ] Make it clear every voice is wanted
- [x] Follow up on what people raise

Priya and Tom will practise the ticked ones first

5 Our Experiments

SMALL CHANGES · CHECK THEM

EXPERIMENT	WHO	CHECK ON
Write silently before discussing ideas	*Tom*	*next retro*
Rotate who facilitates refinement	*everyone*	*in 6 weeks*
Priya shares one mistake at each review	*Priya*	*end of June*

"What would make it easier to say what you really think here?"

"When did someone last speak up, and what happened next?"

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